

A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 46

Corinthians1

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 46*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

1 Corinthians

1 Corinthians 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 I, Paul, have been called and sent by Jesus, the Messiah, according to God's plan, along with my friend Sosthenes.
- 1 Paul, called to be an apostle of Christ Jesus by the will of God, and our brother Sosthenes,
- 2 I send this letter to you in God's church at Corinth, Christians cleaned up by Jesus and set apart for a God-filled life. I include in my greeting all who call out to Jesus, wherever they live. He's their Master as well as ours!
- 2 To the church of God in Corinth, to those sanctified in Christ Jesus and called to be holy, together with all those everywhere who call on the name of our Lord Jesus Christ--their Lord and ours:
- 3 May all the gifts and benefits that come from God our Father, and the Master, Jesus Christ, be yours.
- 3 Grace and peace to you from God our Father and the Lord Jesus Christ.
- 4 Every time I think of you--and I think of you often!--I thank God for your lives of free and open access to God, given by Jesus.
- 4 I always thank God for you because of his grace given you in Christ Jesus.
- 5 There's no end to what has happened in you--it's beyond speech, beyond knowledge.
- 5 For in him you have been enriched in every way--in all your speaking and in all your knowledge--
- 6 The evidence of Christ has been clearly verified in your lives.
- 6 because our testimony about Christ was confirmed in you.
- 7 Just think--you don't need a thing, you've got it all! All God's gifts are right in front of you as you wait expectantly for our Master Jesus to arrive on the scene for the Finale.

- 7 Therefore you do not lack any spiritual gift as you eagerly wait for our Lord Jesus Christ to be revealed.
- 8 And not only that, but God himself is right alongside to keep you steady and on track until things are all wrapped up by Jesus.
- 8 He will keep you strong to the end, so that you will be blameless on the day of our Lord Jesus Christ.
- 9 God, who got you started in this spiritual adventure, shares with us the life of his Son and our Master Jesus. He will never give up on you. Never forget that.
- 9 God, who has called you into fellowship with his Son Jesus Christ our Lord, is faithful.
- 10 I have a serious concern to bring up with you, my friends, using the authority of Jesus, our Master. I'll put it as urgently as I can: You must get along with each other. You must learn to be considerate of one another, cultivating a life in common.
- 10 I appeal to you, brothers, in the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, that all of you agree with one another so that there may be no divisions among you and that you may be perfectly united in mind and thought.
- 11 I bring this up because some from Chloe's family brought a most disturbing report to my attention--that you're fighting among yourselves!
- 11 My brothers, some from Chloe's household have informed me that there are quarrels among you.
- 12 I'll tell you exactly what I was told: You're all picking sides, going around saying, "I'm on Paul's side," or "I'm for Apollos," or "Peter is my man," or "I'm in the Messiah group."
- 12 What I mean is this: One of you says, "I follow Paul"; another, "I follow Apollos"; another, "I follow Cephas"; still another, "I follow Christ."
- 13 I ask you, "Has the Messiah been chopped up in little pieces so we can each have a relic all our own? Was Paul crucified for you? Was a single one of you baptized in Paul's name?"
- 13 Is Christ divided? Was Paul crucified for you? Were you baptized into the name of Paul?
- 14 I was not involved with any of your baptisms--except for Crispus and Gaius--and on getting this report, I'm sure glad I wasn't.
- 14 I am thankful that I did not baptize any of you except Crispus and Gaius,

- 15 At least no one can go around saying he was baptized in my name.
- 15 so no one can say that you were baptized into my name.
- 16 (Come to think of it, I also baptized Stephanas's family, but as far as I can recall, that's it.)
- 16 (Yes, I also baptized the household of Stephanas; beyond that, I don't remember if I baptized anyone else.)
- 17 God didn't send me out to collect a following for myself, but to preach the Message of what he has done, collecting a following for him. And he didn't send me to do it with a lot of fancy rhetoric of my own, lest the powerful action at the center--Christ on the Cross--be trivialized into mere words.
- 17 For Christ did not send me to baptize, but to preach the gospel--not with words of human wisdom, lest the cross of Christ be emptied of its power.
- 18 The Message that points to Christ on the Cross seems like sheer silliness to those hellbent on destruction, but for those on the way of salvation it makes perfect sense. This is the way God works, and most powerfully as it turns out.
- 18 For the message of the cross is foolishness to those who are perishing, but to us who are being saved it is the power of God.
- 19 It's written, I'll turn conventional wisdom on its head, I'll expose so-called experts as crackpots.
- 19 For it is written: "I will destroy the wisdom of the wise; the intelligence of the intelligent I will frustrate."
- 20 So where can you find someone truly wise, truly educated, truly intelligent in this day and age? Hasn't God exposed it all as pretentious nonsense?
- 20 Where is the wise man? Where is the scholar? Where is the philosopher of this age? Has not God made foolish the wisdom of the world?
- 21 Since the world in all its fancy wisdom never had a clue when it came to knowing God, God in his wisdom took delight in using what the world considered dumb--preaching, of all things!--to bring those who trust him into the way of salvation.
- 21 For since in the wisdom of God the world through its wisdom did not know him, God was pleased through the foolishness of what was preached to save those who believe.

22 While Jews clamor for miraculous demonstrations and Greeks go in for philosophical wisdom,
22 Jews demand miraculous signs and Greeks look for wisdom,
23 we go right on proclaiming Christ, the Crucified. Jews treat this like an anti-miracle--and Greeks pass it off as absurd.
23 but we preach Christ crucified: a stumbling block to Jews and foolishness to Gentiles,
24 But to us who are personally called by God himself--both Jews and Greeks--Christ is God's ultimate miracle and wisdom all wrapped up in one.
24 but to those whom God has called, both Jews and Greeks, Christ the power of God and the wisdom of God.
25 Human wisdom is so tinny, so impotent, next to the seeming absurdity of God. Human strength can't begin to compete with God's "weakness."
25 For the foolishness of God is wiser than man's wisdom, and the weakness of God is stronger than man's strength.
26 Take a good look, friends, at who you were when you got called into this life. I don't see many of "the brightest and the best" among you, not many influential, not many from high-society families.
26 Brothers, think of what you were when you were called. Not many of you were wise by human standards; not many were influential; not many were of noble birth.
27 Isn't it obvious that God deliberately chose men and women that the culture overlooks and exploits and abuses,
27 But God chose the foolish things of the world to shame the wise; God chose the weak things of the world to shame the strong.
28 chose these "nobodies" to expose the hollow pretensions of the "somebodies"?
28 He chose the lowly things of this world and the despised things--and the things that are not--to nullify the things that are,
29 That makes it quite clear that none of you can get by with blowing your own horn before God.
29 so that no one may boast before him.
30 Everything that we have--right thinking and right living, a clean slate and a fresh start--comes from God by way of Jesus Christ.

- 30 It is because of him that you are in Christ Jesus, who has become for us wisdom from God--that is, our righteousness, holiness and redemption.
- 31 That's why we have the saying, "If you're going to blow a horn, blow a trumpet for God."
- 31 Therefore, as it is written: "Let him who boasts boast in the Lord."

1 Corinthians 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 You'll remember, friends, that when I first came to you to let you in on God's master stroke, I didn't try to impress you with polished speeches and the latest philosophy.
- 1 When I came to you, brothers, I did not come with eloquence or superior wisdom as I proclaimed to you the testimony about God.
- 2 I deliberately kept it plain and simple: first Jesus and who he is; then Jesus and what he did--Jesus crucified.
- 2 For I resolved to know nothing while I was with you except Jesus Christ and him crucified.
- 3 I was unsure of how to go about this, and felt totally inadequate--I was scared to death, if you want the truth of it--
- 3 I came to you in weakness and fear, and with much trembling.
- 4 and so nothing I said could have impressed you or anyone else. But the Message came through anyway. God's Spirit and God's power did it,
- 4 My message and my preaching were not with wise and persuasive words, but with a demonstration of the Spirit's power,
- 5 which made it clear that your life of faith is a response to God's power, not to some fancy mental or emotional footwork by me or anyone else.
- 5 so that your faith might not rest on men's wisdom, but on God's power.
- 6 We, of course, have plenty of wisdom to pass on to you once you get your feet on firm spiritual ground, but it's not popular wisdom, the fashionable wisdom of high-priced experts that will be out-of-date in a year or so.
- 6 We do, however, speak a message of wisdom among the mature, but not the wisdom of this age or of the rulers of this age, who are coming to nothing.

- 7 God's wisdom is something mysterious that goes deep into the interior of his purposes. You don't find it lying around on the surface. It's not the latest message, but more like the oldest--what God determined as the way to bring out his best in us, long before we ever arrived on the scene.
- 7 No, we speak of God's secret wisdom, a wisdom that has been hidden and that God destined for our glory before time began.
- 8 The experts of our day haven't a clue about what this eternal plan is. If they had, they wouldn't have killed the Master of the God-designed life on a cross.
- 8 None of the rulers of this age understood it, for if they had, they would not have crucified the Lord of glory.
- 9 That's why we have this Scripture text: No one's ever seen or heard anything like this, Never so much as imagined anything quite like it--What God has arranged for those who love him.
- 9 However, as it is written: "No eye has seen, no ear has heard, no mind has conceived what God has prepared for those who love him" --
- 10 But you've seen and heard it because God by his Spirit has brought it all out into the open before you. The Spirit, not content to flit around on the surface, dives into the depths of God, and brings out what God planned all along.
- 10 but God has revealed it to us by his Spirit. The Spirit searches all things, even the deep things of God.
- 11 Who ever knows what you're thinking and planning except you yourself? The same with God--except that he not only knows what he's thinking,
- 11 For who among men knows the thoughts of a man except the man's spirit within him? In the same way no one knows the thoughts of God except the Spirit of God.
- 12 but he lets us in on it. God offers a full report on the gifts of life and salvation that he is giving us.
- 12 We have not received the spirit of the world but the Spirit who is from God, that we may understand what God has freely given us.
- 13 We don't have to rely on the world's guesses and opinions. We didn't learn this by reading books or going to school; we learned it from God, who taught us person-to-person through Jesus, and we're passing it on to you in the same firsthand, personal way.

- 13 This is what we speak, not in words taught us by human wisdom but in words taught by the Spirit, expressing spiritual truths in spiritual words.
- 14 The unspiritual self, just as it is by nature, can't receive the gifts of God's Spirit. There's no capacity for them. They seem like so much silliness. Spirit can be known only by spirit--God's Spirit and our spirits in open communion.
- 14 The man without the Spirit does not accept the things that come from the Spirit of God, for they are foolishness to him, and he cannot understand them, because they are spiritually discerned.
- 15 Spiritually alive, we have access to everything God's Spirit is doing, and can't be judged by unspiritual critics.
- 15 The spiritual man makes judgments about all things, but he himself is not subject to any man's judgment:
- 16 Isaiah's question, "Is there anyone around who knows God's Spirit, anyone who knows what he is doing?" has been answered: Christ knows, and we have Christ's Spirit.
- 16 For who has known the mind of the Lord that he may instruct him? But we have the mind of Christ.

1 Corinthians 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 But for right now, friends, I'm completely frustrated by your unspiritual dealings with each other and with God. You're acting like infants in relation to Christ,
- 1 Brothers, I could not address you as spiritual but as worldly--mere infants in Christ.
- 2 capable of nothing much more than nursing at the breast. Well, then, I'll nurse you since you don't seem capable of anything more.
- 2 I gave you milk, not solid food, for you were not yet ready for it. Indeed, you are still not ready.
- 3 As long as you grab for what makes you feel good or makes you look important, are you really much different than a babe at the breast, content only when everything's going your way?

- 3 You are still worldly. For since there is jealousy and quarreling among you, are you not worldly? Are you not acting like mere men?
- 4 When one of you says, "I'm on Paul's side," and another says, "I'm for Apollos," aren't you being totally infantile?
- 4 For when one says, "I follow Paul," and another, "I follow Apollos," are you not mere men?
- 5 Who do you think Paul is, anyway? Or Apollos, for that matter? Servants, both of us--servants who waited on you as you gradually learned to entrust your lives to our mutual Master. We each carried out our servant assignment.
- 5 What, after all, is Apollos? And what is Paul? Only servants, through whom you came to believe--as the Lord has assigned to each his task.
- 6 I planted the seed, Apollos watered the plants, but God made you grow.
- 6 I planted the seed, Apollos watered it, but God made it grow.
- 7 It's not the one who plants or the one who waters who is at the center of this process but God, who makes things grow.
- 7 So neither he who plants nor he who waters is anything, but only God, who makes things grow.
- 8 Planting and watering are menial servant jobs at minimum wages.
- 8 The man who plants and the man who waters have one purpose, and each will be rewarded according to his own labor.
- 9 What makes them worth doing is the God we are serving. You happen to be God's field in which we are working. Or, to put it another way, you are God's house.
- 9 For we are God's fellow workers; you are God's field, God's building.
- 10 Using the gift God gave me as a good architect, I designed blueprints; Apollos is putting up the walls. Let each carpenter who comes on the job take care to build on the foundation!
- 10 By the grace God has given me, I laid a foundation as an expert builder, and someone else is building on it. But each one should be careful how he builds.
- 11 Remember, there is only one foundation, the one already laid: Jesus Christ.
- 11 For no one can lay any foundation other than the one already laid, which is Jesus Christ.
- 12 Take particular care in picking out your building materials.

- 12 If any man builds on this foundation using gold, silver, costly stones, wood, hay or straw,
- 13 Eventually there is going to be an inspection. If you use cheap or inferior materials, you'll be found out. The inspection will be thorough and rigorous. You won't get by with a thing.
- 13 his work will be shown for what it is, because the Day will bring it to light. It will be revealed with fire, and the fire will test the quality of each man's work.
- 14 If your work passes inspection, fine;
- 14 If what he has built survives, he will receive his reward.
- 15 if it doesn't, your part of the building will be torn out and started over. But you won't be torn out; you'll survive--but just barely.
- 15 If it is burned up, he will suffer loss; he himself will be saved, but only as one escaping through the flames.
- 16 You realize, don't you, that you are the temple of God, and God himself is present in you?
- 16 Don't you know that you yourselves are God's temple and that God's Spirit lives in you?
- 17 No one will get by with vandalizing God's temple, you can be sure of that. God's temple is sacred--and you, remember, are the temple.
- 17 If anyone destroys God's temple, God will destroy him; for God's temple is sacred, and you are that temple.
- 18 Don't fool yourself. Don't think that you can be wise merely by being up-to-date with the times.
- 18 Do not deceive yourselves. If any one of you thinks he is wise by the standards of this age, he should become a "fool" so that he may become wise.
- 19 Be God's fool--that's the path to true wisdom. What the world calls smart, God calls stupid. It's written in Scripture, He exposes the chicanery of the chic.
- 19 For the wisdom of this world is foolishness in God's sight. As it is written: "He catches the wise in their craftiness" ;
- 20 The Master sees through the smoke screens of the know-it-alls.
- 20 and again, "The Lord knows that the thoughts of the wise are futile."
- 21 I don't want to hear any of you bragging about yourself or anyone else. Everything is already yours as a gift--

- 21 So then, no more boasting about men! All things are yours,
22 Paul, Apollos, Peter, the world, life, death, the present, the future--all of it is yours,
22 whether Paul or Apollos or Cephas or the world or life or death or the present or the future--all are yours,
23 and you are privileged to be in union with Christ, who is in union with God.
23 and you are of Christ, and Christ is of God.

1 Corinthians 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 Don't imagine us leaders to be something we aren't. We are servants of Christ, not his masters. We are guides into God's most sublime secrets, not security guards posted to protect them.
- 1 So then, men ought to regard us as servants of Christ and as those entrusted with the secret things of God.
- 2 The requirements for a good guide are reliability and accurate knowledge.
- 2 Now it is required that those who have been given a trust must prove faithful.
- 3 It matters very little to me what you think of me, even less where I rank in popular opinion. I don't even rank myself. Comparisons in these matters are pointless.
- 3 I care very little if I am judged by you or by any human court; indeed, I do not even judge myself.
- 4 I'm not aware of anything that would disqualify me from being a good guide for you, but that doesn't mean much. The Master makes that judgment.
- 4 My conscience is clear, but that does not make me innocent. It is the Lord who judges me.
- 5 So don't get ahead of the Master and jump to conclusions with your judgments before all the evidence is in. When he comes, he will bring out in the open and place in evidence all kinds of things we never even

dreamed of--inner motives and purposes and prayers. Only then will any one of us get to hear the "Well done!" of God.

- 5 Therefore judge nothing before the appointed time; wait till the Lord comes. He will bring to light what is hidden in darkness and will expose the motives of men's hearts. At that time each will receive his praise from God.
- 6 All I'm doing right now, friends, is showing how these things pertain to Apollos and me so that you will learn restraint and not rush into making judgments without knowing all the facts. It's important to look at things from God's point of view. I would rather not see you inflating or deflating reputations based on mere hearsay.
- 6 Now, brothers, I have applied these things to myself and Apollos for your benefit, so that you may learn from us the meaning of the saying, "Do not go beyond what is written." Then you will not take pride in one man over against another.
- 7 For who do you know that really knows you, knows your heart? And even if they did, is there anything they would discover in you that you could take credit for? Isn't everything you have and everything you are sheer gifts from God? So what's the point of all this comparing and competing?
- 7 For who makes you different from anyone else? What do you have that you did not receive? And if you did receive it, why do you boast as though you did not?
- 8 You already have all you need. You already have more access to God than you can handle. Without bringing either Apollos or me into it, you're sitting on top of the world--at least God's world--and we're right there, sitting alongside you!
- 8 Already you have all you want! Already you have become rich! You have become kings--and that without us! How I wish that you really had become kings so that we might be kings with you!
- 9 It seems to me that God has put us who bear his Message on stage in a theater in which no one wants to buy a ticket. We're something everyone stands around and stares at, like an accident in the street.
- 9 For it seems to me that God has put us apostles on display at the end of the procession, like men condemned to die in the arena. We have been made a spectacle to the whole universe, to angels as well as to men.

- 10 We're the Messiah's misfits. You might be sure of yourselves, but we live in the midst of frailties and uncertainties. You might be well-thought-of by others, but we're mostly kicked around.
- 10 We are fools for Christ, but you are so wise in Christ! We are weak, but you are strong! You are honored, we are dishonored!
- 11 Much of the time we don't have enough to eat, we wear patched and threadbare clothes, we get doors slammed in our faces,
- 11 To this very hour we go hungry and thirsty, we are in rags, we are brutally treated, we are homeless.
- 12 and we pick up odd jobs anywhere we can to eke out a living. When they call us names, we say, "God bless you."
- 12 We work hard with our own hands. When we are cursed, we bless; when we are persecuted, we endure it;
- 13 When they spread rumors about us, we put in a good word for them. We're treated like garbage, potato peelings from the culture's kitchen. And it's not getting any better.
- 13 when we are slandered, we answer kindly. Up to this moment we have become the scum of the earth, the refuse of the world.
- 14 I'm not writing all this as a neighborhood scold just to make you feel rotten. I'm writing as a father to you, my children. I love you and want you to grow up well, not spoiled.
- 14 I am not writing this to shame you, but to warn you, as my dear children.
- 15 There are a lot of people around who can't wait to tell you what you've done wrong, but there aren't many fathers willing to take the time and effort to help you grow up. It was as Jesus helped me proclaim God's Message to you that I became your father.
- 15 Even though you have ten thousand guardians in Christ, you do not have many fathers, for in Christ Jesus I became your father through the gospel.
- 16 I'm not, you know, asking you to do anything I'm not already doing myself.
- 16 Therefore I urge you to imitate me.
- 17 This is why I sent Timothy to you earlier. He is also my dear son, and true to the Master. He will refresh your memory on the instructions I regularly give all the churches on the way of Christ.

- 17 For this reason I am sending to you Timothy, my son whom I love, who is faithful in the Lord. He will remind you of my way of life in Christ Jesus, which agrees with what I teach everywhere in every church.
- 18 I know there are some among you who are so full of themselves they never listen to anyone, let alone me. They don't think I'll ever show up in person.
- 18 Some of you have become arrogant, as if I were not coming to you.
- 19 But I'll be there sooner than you think, God willing, and then we'll see if they're full of anything but hot air.
- 19 But I will come to you very soon, if the Lord is willing, and then I will find out not only how these arrogant people are talking, but what power they have.
- 20 God's Way is not a matter of mere talk; it's an empowered life.
- 20 For the kingdom of God is not a matter of talk but of power.
- 21 So how should I prepare to come to you? As a severe disciplinarian who makes you toe the mark? Or as a good friend and counselor who wants to share heart-to-heart with you? You decide.
- 21 What do you prefer? Shall I come to you with a whip, or in love and with a gentle spirit?

1 Corinthians 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 I also received a report of scandalous sex within your church family, a kind that wouldn't be tolerated even outside the church: One of your men is sleeping with his stepmother.
- 1 It is actually reported that there is sexual immorality among you, and of a kind that does not occur even among pagans: A man has his father's wife.
- 2 And you're so above it all that it doesn't even faze you! Shouldn't this break your hearts? Shouldn't it bring you to your knees in tears? Shouldn't this person and his conduct be confronted and dealt with?
- 2 And you are proud! Shouldn't you rather have been filled with grief and have put out of your fellowship the man who did this?

- 3 I'll tell you what I would do. Even though I'm not there in person, consider me right there with you, because I can fully see what's going on. I'm telling you that this is wrong. You must not simply look the other way and hope it goes away on its own. Bring it out in the open and deal with it in the authority of Jesus our Master.
- 3 Even though I am not physically present, I am with you in spirit. And I have already passed judgment on the one who did this, just as if I were present.
- 4 Assemble the community--I'll be present in spirit with you and our Master Jesus will be present in power.
- 4 When you are assembled in the name of our Lord Jesus and I am with you in spirit, and the power of our Lord Jesus is present,
- 5 Hold this man's conduct up to public scrutiny. Let him defend it if he can! But if he can't, then out with him! It will be totally devastating to him, of course, and embarrassing to you. But better devastation and embarrassment than damnation. You want him on his feet and forgiven before the Master on the Day of Judgment.
- 5 hand this man over to Satan, so that the sinful nature may be destroyed and his spirit saved on the day of the Lord.
- 6 Your flip and callous arrogance in these things bothers me. You pass it off as a small thing, but it's anything but that. Yeast, too, is a "small thing," but it works its way through a whole batch of bread dough pretty fast.
- 6 Your boasting is not good. Don't you know that a little yeast works through the whole batch of dough?
- 7 So get rid of this "yeast." Our true identity is flat and plain, not puffed up with the wrong kind of ingredient. The Messiah, our Passover Lamb, has already been sacrificed for the Passover meal, and we are the Unraised Bread part of the Feast.
- 7 Get rid of the old yeast that you may be a new batch without yeast--as you really are. For Christ, our Passover lamb, has been sacrificed.
- 8 So let's live out our part in the Feast, not as raised bread swollen with the yeast of evil, but as flat bread--simple, genuine, unpretentious.
- 8 Therefore let us keep the Festival, not with the old yeast, the yeast of malice and wickedness, but with bread without yeast, the bread of sincerity and truth.

- 9 I wrote you in my earlier letter that you shouldn't make yourselves at home among the sexually promiscuous.
- 9 I have written you in my letter not to associate with sexually immoral people--
- 10 I didn't mean that you should have nothing at all to do with outsiders of that sort. Or with crooks, whether blue- or white-collar. Or with spiritual phonies, for that matter. You'd have to leave the world entirely to do that!
- 10 not at all meaning the people of this world who are immoral, or the greedy and swindlers, or idolaters. In that case you would have to leave this world.
- 11 But I am saying that you shouldn't act as if everything is just fine when one of your Christian companions is promiscuous or crooked, is flip with God or rude to friends, gets drunk or becomes greedy and predatory. You can't just go along with this, treating it as acceptable behavior.
- 11 But now I am writing you that you must not associate with anyone who calls himself a brother but is sexually immoral or greedy, an idolater or a slanderer, a drunkard or a swindler. With such a man do not even eat.
- 12 I'm not responsible for what the outsiders do, but don't we have some responsibility for those within our community of believers?
- 12 What business is it of mine to judge those outside the church? Are you not to judge those inside?
- 13 God decides on the outsiders, but we need to decide when our brothers and sisters are out of line and, if necessary, clean house.
- 13 God will judge those outside. "Expel the wicked man from among you."

1 Corinthians 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 And how dare you take each other to court! When you think you have been wronged, does it make any sense to go before a court that knows nothing of God's ways instead of a family of Christians?
- 1 If any of you has a dispute with another, dare he take it before the ungodly for judgment instead of before the saints?
- 2 The day is coming when the world is going to stand before a jury made up of Christians. If someday you are going to rule on the world's fate,

- wouldn't it be a good idea to practice on some of these smaller cases?
- 2 Do you not know that the saints will judge the world? And if you are to judge the world, are you not competent to judge trivial cases?
 - 3 Why, we're even going to judge angels! So why not these everyday affairs?
 - 3 Do you not know that we will judge angels? How much more the things of this life!
 - 4 As these disagreements and wrongs surface, why would you ever entrust them to the judgment of people you don't trust in any other way?
 - 4 Therefore, if you have disputes about such matters, appoint as judges even men of little account in the church!
 - 5 I say this as bluntly as I can to wake you up to the stupidity of what you're doing. Is it possible that there isn't one levelheaded person among you who can make fair decisions when disagreements and disputes come up? I don't believe it.
 - 5 I say this to shame you. Is it possible that there is nobody among you wise enough to judge a dispute between believers?
 - 6 And here you are taking each other to court before people who don't even believe in God! How can they render justice if they don't believe in the God of justice?
 - 6 But instead, one brother goes to law against another--and this in front of unbelievers!
 - 7 These court cases are an ugly blot on your community. Wouldn't it be far better to just take it, to let yourselves be wronged and forget it?
 - 7 The very fact that you have lawsuits among you means you have been completely defeated already. Why not rather be wronged? Why not rather be cheated?
 - 8 All you're doing is providing fuel for more wrong, more injustice, bringing more hurt to the people of your own spiritual family.
 - 8 Instead, you yourselves cheat and do wrong, and you do this to your brothers.
 - 9 Don't you realize that this is not the way to live? Unjust people who don't care about God will not be joining in his kingdom. Those who use and abuse each other, use and abuse sex,
 - 9 Do you not know that the wicked will not inherit the kingdom of God? Do not be deceived: Neither the sexually immoral nor idolaters nor

- adulterers nor male prostitutes nor homosexual offenders
- 10 use and abuse the earth and everything in it, don't qualify as citizens in God's kingdom.
- 10 nor thieves nor the greedy nor drunkards nor slanderers nor swindlers will inherit the kingdom of God.
- 11 A number of you know from experience what I'm talking about, for not so long ago you were on that list. Since then, you've been cleaned up and given a fresh start by Jesus, our Master, our Messiah, and by our God present in us, the Spirit.
- 11 And that is what some of you were. But you were washed, you were sanctified, you were justified in the name of the Lord Jesus Christ and by the Spirit of our God.
- 12 Just because something is technically legal doesn't mean that it's spiritually appropriate. If I went around doing whatever I thought I could get by with, I'd be a slave to my whims.
- 12 Everything is permissible for me--but not everything is beneficial. "Everything is permissible for me"--but I will not be mastered by anything.
- 13 You know the old saying, "First you eat to live, and then you live to eat"? Well, it may be true that the body is only a temporary thing, but that's no excuse for stuffing your body with food, or indulging it with sex. Since the Master honors you with a body, honor him with your body!
- 13 Food for the stomach and the stomach for food--but God will destroy them both. The body is not meant for sexual immorality, but for the Lord, and the Lord for the body.
- 14 God honored the Master's body by raising it from the grave. He'll treat yours with the same resurrection power.
- 14 By his power God raised the Lord from the dead, and he will raise us also.
- 15 Until that time, remember that your bodies are created with the same dignity as the Master's body. You wouldn't take the Master's body off to a whorehouse, would you? I should hope not.
- 15 Do you not know that your bodies are members of Christ himself? Shall I then take the members of Christ and unite them with a prostitute? Never!

- 16 There's more to sex than mere skin on skin. Sex is as much spiritual mystery as physical fact. As written in Scripture, "The two become one."
- 16 Do you not know that he who unites himself with a prostitute is one with her in body? For it is said, "The two will become one flesh."
- 17 Since we want to become spiritually one with the Master, we must not pursue the kind of sex that avoids commitment and intimacy, leaving us more lonely than ever--the kind of sex that can never "become one."
- 17 But he who unites himself with the Lord is one with him in spirit.
- 18 There is a sense in which sexual sins are different from all others. In sexual sin we violate the sacredness of our own bodies, these bodies that were made for God-given and God-modeled love, for "becoming one" with another.
- 18 Flee from sexual immorality. All other sins a man commits are outside his body, but he who sins sexually sins against his own body.
- 19 Or didn't you realize that your body is a sacred place, the place of the Holy Spirit? Don't you see that you can't live however you please, squandering what God paid such a high price for? The physical part of you is not some piece of property belonging to the spiritual part of you.
- 19 Do you not know that your body is a temple of the Holy Spirit, who is in you, whom you have received from God? You are not your own;
- 20 God owns the whole works. So let people see God in and through your body.
- 20 you were bought at a price. Therefore honor God with your body.

1 Corinthians 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 Now, getting down to the questions you asked in your letter to me. First, Is it a good thing to have sexual relations?
- 1 Now for the matters you wrote about: It is good for a man not to marry.
- 2 Certainly--but only within a certain context. It's good for a man to have a wife, and for a woman to have a husband. Sexual drives are strong, but marriage is strong enough to contain them and provide for a balanced and fulfilling sexual life in a world of sexual disorder.

- 2 But since there is so much immorality, each man should have his own wife, and each woman her own husband.
- 3 The marriage bed must be a place of mutuality--the husband seeking to satisfy his wife, the wife seeking to satisfy her husband.
- 3 The husband should fulfill his marital duty to his wife, and likewise the wife to her husband.
- 4 Marriage is not a place to "stand up for your rights." Marriage is a decision to serve the other, whether in bed or out.
- 4 The wife's body does not belong to her alone but also to her husband. In the same way, the husband's body does not belong to him alone but also to his wife.
- 5 Abstaining from sex is permissible for a period of time if you both agree to it, and if it's for the purposes of prayer and fasting--but only for such times. Then come back together again. Satan has an ingenious way of tempting us when we least expect it.
- 5 Do not deprive each other except by mutual consent and for a time, so that you may devote yourselves to prayer. Then come together again so that Satan will not tempt you because of your lack of self-control.
- 6 I'm not, understand, commanding these periods of abstinence--only providing my best counsel if you should choose them.
- 6 I say this as a concession, not as a command.
- 7 Sometimes I wish everyone were single like me--a simpler life in many ways! But celibacy is not for everyone any more than marriage is. God gives the gift of the single life to some, the gift of the married life to others.
- 7 I wish that all men were as I am. But each man has his own gift from God; one has this gift, another has that.
- 8 I do, though, tell the unmarried and widows that singleness might well be the best thing for them, as it has been for me.
- 8 Now to the unmarried and the widows I say: It is good for them to stay unmarried, as I am.
- 9 But if they can't manage their desires and emotions, they should by all means go ahead and get married. The difficulties of marriage are preferable by far to a sexually tortured life as a single.
- 9 But if they cannot control themselves, they should marry, for it is better to marry than to burn with passion.

- 10 And if you are married, stay married. This is the Master's command, not mine.
- 10 To the married I give this command (not I, but the Lord): A wife must not separate from her husband.
- 11 If a wife should leave her husband, she must either remain single or else come back and make things right with him. And a husband has no right to get rid of his wife.
- 11 But if she does, she must remain unmarried or else be reconciled to her husband. And a husband must not divorce his wife.
- 12 For the rest of you who are in mixed marriages--Christian married to nonChristian--we have no explicit command from the Master. So this is what you must do. If you are a man with a wife who is not a believer but who still wants to live with you, hold on to her.
- 12 To the rest I say this (I, not the Lord): If any brother has a wife who is not a believer and she is willing to live with him, he must not divorce her.
- 13 If you are a woman with a husband who is not a believer but he wants to live with you, hold on to him.
- 13 And if a woman has a husband who is not a believer and he is willing to live with her, she must not divorce him.
- 14 The unbelieving husband shares to an extent in the holiness of his wife, and the unbelieving wife is likewise touched by the holiness of her husband. Otherwise, your children would be left out; as it is, they also are included in the spiritual purposes of God.
- 14 For the unbelieving husband has been sanctified through his wife, and the unbelieving wife has been sanctified through her believing husband. Otherwise your children would be unclean, but as it is, they are holy.
- 15 On the other hand, if the unbelieving spouse walks out, you've got to let him or her go. You don't have to hold on desperately. God has called us to make the best of it, as peacefully as we can.
- 15 But if the unbeliever leaves, let him do so. A believing man or woman is not bound in such circumstances; God has called us to live in peace.
- 16 You never know, wife: The way you handle this might bring your husband not only back to you but to God. You never know, husband: The way you handle this might bring your wife not only back to you but to God.

- 16 How do you know, wife, whether you will save your husband? Or, how do you know, husband, whether you will save your wife?
- 17 And don't be wishing you were someplace else or with someone else. Where you are right now is God's place for you. Live and obey and love and believe right there. God, not your marital status, defines your life. Don't think I'm being harder on you than on the others. I give this same counsel in all the churches.
- 17 Nevertheless, each one should retain the place in life that the Lord assigned to him and to which God has called him. This is the rule I lay down in all the churches.
- 18 Were you Jewish at the time God called you? Don't try to remove the evidence. Were you non-Jewish at the time of your call? Don't become a Jew.
- 18 Was a man already circumcised when he was called? He should not become uncircumcised. Was a man uncircumcised when he was called? He should not be circumcised.
- 19 Being Jewish isn't the point. The really important thing is obeying God's call, following his commands.
- 19 Circumcision is nothing and uncircumcision is nothing. Keeping God's commands is what counts.
- 20 Stay where you were when God called your name.
- 20 Each one should remain in the situation which he was in when God called him.
- 21 Were you a slave? Slavery is no roadblock to obeying and believing. I don't mean you're stuck and can't leave. If you have a chance at freedom, go ahead and take it.
- 21 Were you a slave when you were called? Don't let it trouble you--although if you can gain your freedom, do so.
- 22 I'm simply trying to point out that under your new Master you're going to experience a marvelous freedom you would never have dreamed of. On the other hand, if you were free when Christ called you, you'll experience a delightful "enslavement to God" you would never have dreamed of.
- 22 For he who was a slave when he was called by the Lord is the Lord's freedman; similarly, he who was a free man when he was called is Christ's slave.

- 23 All of you, slave and free both, were once held hostage in a sinful society. Then a huge sum was paid out for your ransom. So please don't, out of old habit, slip back into being or doing what everyone else tells you.
- 23 You were bought at a price; do not become slaves of men.
- 24 Friends, stay where you were called to be. God is there. Hold the high ground with him at your side.
- 24 Brothers, each man, as responsible to God, should remain in the situation God called him to.
- 25 The Master did not give explicit direction regarding virgins, but as one much experienced in the mercy of the Master and loyal to him all the way, you can trust my counsel.
- 25 Now about virgins: I have no command from the Lord, but I give a judgment as one who by the Lord's mercy is trustworthy.
- 26 Because of the current pressures on us from all sides, I think it would probably be best to stay just as you are.
- 26 Because of the present crisis, I think that it is good for you to remain as you are.
- 27 Are you married? Stay married. Are you unmarried? Don't get married.
- 27 Are you married? Do not seek a divorce. Are you unmarried? Do not look for a wife.
- 28 But there's certainly no sin in getting married, whether you're a virgin or not. All I am saying is that when you marry, you take on additional stress in an already stressful time, and I want to spare you if possible.
- 28 But if you do marry, you have not sinned; and if a virgin marries, she has not sinned. But those who marry will face many troubles in this life, and I want to spare you this.
- 29 I do want to point out, friends, that time is of the essence. There is no time to waste, so don't complicate your lives unnecessarily. Keep it simple--in marriage,
- 29 What I mean, brothers, is that the time is short. From now on those who have wives should live as if they had none;
- 30 grief, joy, whatever. Even in ordinary things--your daily routines of shopping, and so on.
- 30 those who mourn, as if they did not; those who are happy, as if they were not; those who buy something, as if it were not theirs to keep;

- 31 Deal as sparingly as possible with the things the world thrusts on you. This world as you see it is on its way out.
- 31 those who use the things of the world, as if not engrossed in them. For this world in its present form is passing away.
- 32 I want you to live as free of complications as possible. When you're unmarried, you're free to concentrate on simply pleasing the Master.
- 32 I would like you to be free from concern. An unmarried man is concerned about the Lord's affairs--how he can please the Lord.
- 33 Marriage involves you in all the nuts and bolts of domestic life and in wanting to please your spouse,
- 33 But a married man is concerned about the affairs of this world--how he can please his wife--
- 34 leading to so many more demands on your attention. The time and energy that married people spend on caring for and nurturing each other, the unmarried can spend in becoming whole and holy instruments of God.
- 34 and his interests are divided. An unmarried woman or virgin is concerned about the Lord's affairs: Her aim is to be devoted to the Lord in both body and spirit. But a married woman is concerned about the affairs of this world--how she can please her husband.
- 35 I'm trying to be helpful and make it as easy as possible for you, not make things harder. All I want is for you to be able to develop a way of life in which you can spend plenty of time together with the Master without a lot of distractions.
- 35 I am saying this for your own good, not to restrict you, but that you may live in a right way in undivided devotion to the Lord.
- 36 If a man has a woman friend to whom he is loyal but never intended to marry, having decided to serve God as a "single," and then changes his mind, deciding he should marry her, he should go ahead and marry. It's no sin; it's not even a "step down" from celibacy, as some say.
- 36 If anyone thinks he is acting improperly toward the virgin he is engaged to, and if she is getting along in years and he feels he ought to marry, he should do as he wants. He is not sinning. They should get married.
- 37 On the other hand, if a man is comfortable in his decision for a single life in service to God and it's entirely his own conviction and not imposed on him by others, he ought to stick with it.

- 37 But the man who has settled the matter in his own mind, who is under no compulsion but has control over his own will, and who has made up his mind not to marry the virgin--this man also does the right thing.
- 38 Marriage is spiritually and morally right and not inferior to singleness in any way, although as I indicated earlier, because of the times we live in, I do have pastoral reasons for encouraging singleness.
- 38 So then, he who marries the virgin does right, but he who does not marry her does even better.
- 39 A wife must stay with her husband as long as he lives. If he dies, she is free to marry anyone she chooses. She will, of course, want to marry a believer and have the blessing of the Master
- 39 A woman is bound to her husband as long as he lives. But if her husband dies, she is free to marry anyone she wishes, but he must belong to the Lord.
- 40 . By now you know that I think she'll be better off staying single. The Master, in my opinion, thinks so, too.
- 40 In my judgment, she is happier if she stays as she is--and I think that I too have the Spirit of God.

1 Corinthians 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 The question keeps coming up regarding meat that has been offered up to an idol: Should you attend meals where such meat is served, or not? We sometimes tend to think we know all we need to know to answer these kinds of questions--
- 1 Now about food sacrificed to idols: We know that we all possess knowledge. Knowledge puffs up, but love builds up.
- 2 but sometimes our humble hearts can help us more than our proud minds.
- 2 The man who thinks he knows something does not yet know as he ought to know.
- 3 We never really know enough until we recognize that God alone knows it all.
- 3 But the man who loves God is known by God.

- 4 Some people say, quite rightly, that idols have no actual existence, that there's nothing to them, that there is no God other than our one God,
- 4 So then, about eating food sacrificed to idols: We know that an idol is nothing at all in the world and that there is no God but one.
- 5 that no matter how many of these so-called gods are named and worshiped they still don't add up to anything but a tall story.
- 5 For even if there are so-called gods, whether in heaven or on earth (as indeed there are many "gods" and many "lords"),
- 6 They say--again, quite rightly--that there is only one God the Father, that everything comes from him, and that he wants us to live for him. Also, they say that there is only one Master--Jesus the Messiah--and that everything is for his sake, including us. Yes. It's true.
- 6 yet for us there is but one God, the Father, from whom all things came and for whom we live; and there is but one Lord, Jesus Christ, through whom all things came and through whom we live.
- 7 In strict logic, then, nothing happened to the meat when it was offered up to an idol. It's just like any other meat. I know that, and you know that. But knowing isn't everything. If it becomes everything, some people end up as know-it-alls who treat others as know-nothings. Real knowledge isn't that insensitive. We need to be sensitive to the fact that we're not all at the same level of understanding in this. Some of you have spent your entire lives eating "idol meat," and are sure that there's something bad in the meat that then becomes something bad inside of you. An imagination and conscience shaped under those conditions isn't going to change overnight.
- 7 But not everyone knows this. Some people are still so accustomed to idols that when they eat such food they think of it as having been sacrificed to an idol, and since their conscience is weak, it is defiled.
- 8 But fortunately God doesn't grade us on our diet. We're neither commended when we clean our plate nor reprimanded when we just can't stomach it.
- 8 But food does not bring us near to God; we are no worse if we do not eat, and no better if we do.
- 9 But God does care when you use your freedom carelessly in a way that leads a Christian still vulnerable to those old associations to be thrown off track.

- 9 Be careful, however, that the exercise of your freedom does not become a stumbling block to the weak.
- 10 For instance, say you flaunt your freedom by going to a banquet thrown in honor of idols, where the main course is meat sacrificed to idols. Isn't there great danger if someone still struggling over this issue, someone who looks up to you as knowledgeable and mature, sees you go into that banquet? The danger is that he will become terribly confused--maybe even to the point of getting mixed up himself in what his conscience tells him is wrong.
- 10 For if anyone with a weak conscience sees you who have this knowledge eating in an idol's temple, won't he be emboldened to eat what has been sacrificed to idols?
- 11 Christ gave up his life for that person. Wouldn't you at least be willing to give up going to dinner for him--because, as you say, it doesn't really make any difference? But it does make a difference if you hurt your friend terribly, risking his eternal ruin!
- 11 So this weak brother, for whom Christ died, is destroyed by your knowledge.
- 12 When you hurt your friend, you hurt Christ. A free meal here and there isn't worth it at the cost of even one of these "weak ones."
- 12 When you sin against your brothers in this way and wound their weak conscience, you sin against Christ.
- 13 So, never go to these idol-tainted meals if there's any chance it will trip up one of your brothers or sisters.
- 13 Therefore, if what I eat causes my brother to fall into sin, I will never eat meat again, so that I will not cause him to fall.

1 Corinthians 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 And don't tell me that I have no authority to write like this. I'm perfectly free to do this--isn't that obvious? Haven't I been given a job to do? Wasn't I commissioned to this work in a face-to-face meeting with Jesus, our Master? Aren't you yourselves proof of the good work that I've done for the Master?

- 1 Am I not free? Am I not an apostle? Have I not seen Jesus our Lord? Are you not the result of my work in the Lord?
- 2 Even if no one else admits the authority of my commission, you can't deny it. Why, my work with you is living proof of my authority!
- 2 Even though I may not be an apostle to others, surely I am to you! For you are the seal of my apostleship in the Lord.
- 3 I'm not shy in standing up to my critics.
- 3 This is my defense to those who sit in judgment on me.
- 4 We who are on missionary assignments for God have a right to decent accommodations,
- 4 Don't we have the right to food and drink?
- 5 and we have a right to support for us and our families. You don't seem to have raised questions with the other apostles and our Master's brothers and Peter in these matters.
- 5 Don't we have the right to take a believing wife along with us, as do the other apostles and the Lord's brothers and Cephas?
- 6 So, why me? Is it just Barnabas and I who have to go it alone and pay our own way?
- 6 Or is it only I and Barnabas who must work for a living?
- 7 Are soldiers self-employed? Are gardeners forbidden to eat vegetables from their own gardens? Don't milkmaids get to drink their fill from the pail?
- 7 Who serves as a soldier at his own expense? Who plants a vineyard and does not eat of its grapes? Who tends a flock and does not drink of the milk?
- 8 I'm not just sounding off because I'm irritated. This is all written in the scriptural law.
- 8 Do I say this merely from a human point of view? Doesn't the Law say the same thing?
- 9 Moses wrote, "Don't muzzle an ox to keep it from eating the grain when it's threshing." Do you think Moses' primary concern was the care of farm animals?
- 9 For it is written in the Law of Moses: "Do not muzzle an ox while it is treading out the grain." Is it about oxen that God is concerned?
- 10 Don't you think his concern extends to us? Of course. Farmers plow and thresh expecting something when the crop comes in.

- 10 Surely he says this for us, doesn't he? Yes, this was written for us, because when the plowman plows and the thresher threshes, they ought to do so in the hope of sharing in the harvest.
- 11 So if we have planted spiritual seed among you, is it out of line to expect a meal or two from you?
- 11 If we have sown spiritual seed among you, is it too much if we reap a material harvest from you?
- 12 Others demand plenty from you in these ways. Don't we who have never demanded deserve even more? But we're not going to start demanding now what we've always had a perfect right to. Our decision all along has been to put up with anything rather than to get in the way or detract from the Message of Christ.
- 12 If others have this right of support from you, shouldn't we have it all the more? But we did not use this right. On the contrary, we put up with anything rather than hinder the gospel of Christ.
- 13 All I'm concerned with right now is that you not use our decision to take advantage of others, depriving them of what is rightly theirs. You know, don't you, that it's always been taken for granted that those who work in the Temple live off the proceeds of the Temple, and that those who offer sacrifices at the altar eat their meals from what has been sacrificed?
- 13 Don't you know that those who work in the temple get their food from the temple, and those who serve at the altar share in what is offered on the altar?
- 14 Along the same lines, the Master directed that those who spread the Message be supported by those who believe the Message.
- 14 In the same way, the Lord has commanded that those who preach the gospel should receive their living from the gospel.
- 15 Still, I want it made clear that I've never gotten anything out of this for myself, and that I'm not writing now to get something. I'd rather die than give anyone ammunition to discredit me or impugn my motives.
- 15 But I have not used any of these rights. And I am not writing this in the hope that you will do such things for me. I would rather die than have anyone deprive me of this boast.
- 16 If I proclaim the Message, it's not to get something out of it for myself. I'm compelled to do it, and doomed if I don't!

- 16 Yet when I preach the gospel, I cannot boast, for I am compelled to preach. Woe to me if I do not preach the gospel!
- 17 If this was my own idea of just another way to make a living, I'd expect some pay. But since it's not my idea but something solemnly entrusted to me, why would I expect to get paid?
- 17 If I preach voluntarily, I have a reward; if not voluntarily, I am simply discharging the trust committed to me.
- 18 So am I getting anything out of it? Yes, as a matter of fact: the pleasure of proclaiming the Message at no cost to you. You don't even have to pay my expenses!
- 18 What then is my reward? Just this: that in preaching the gospel I may offer it free of charge, and so not make use of my rights in preaching it.
- 19 Even though I am free of the demands and expectations of everyone, I have voluntarily become a servant to any and all in order to reach a wide range of people:
- 19 Though I am free and belong to no man, I make myself a slave to everyone, to win as many as possible.
- 20 religious, nonreligious,
- 20 To the Jews I became like a Jew, to win the Jews. To those under the law I became like one under the law (though I myself am not under the law), so as to win those under the law.
- 21 meticulous moralists, loose-living immoralists,
- 21 To those not having the law I became like one not having the law (though I am not free from God's law but am under Christ's law), so as to win those not having the law.
- 22 the defeated, the demoralized--whoever. I didn't take on their way of life. I kept my bearings in Christ--but I entered their world and tried to experience things from their point of view. I've become just about every sort of servant there is in my attempts to lead those I meet into a God-saved life.
- 22 To the weak I became weak, to win the weak. I have become all things to all men so that by all possible means I might save some.
- 23 I did all this because of the Message. I didn't just want to talk about it; I wanted to be in on it!
- 23 I do all this for the sake of the gospel, that I may share in its blessings.

- 24 You've all been to the stadium and seen the athletes race. Everyone runs; one wins. Run to win.
- 24 Do you not know that in a race all the runners run, but only one gets the prize? Run in such a way as to get the prize.
- 25 All good athletes train hard. They do it for a gold medal that tarnishes and fades. You're after one that's gold eternally.
- 25 Everyone who competes in the games goes into strict training. They do it to get a crown that will not last; but we do it to get a crown that will last forever.
- 26 I don't know about you, but I'm running hard for the finish line. I'm giving it everything I've got. No sloppy living for me!
- 26 Therefore I do not run like a man running aimlessly; I do not fight like a man beating the air.
- 27 I'm staying alert and in top condition. I'm not going to get caught napping, telling everyone else all about it and then missing out myself.
- 27 No, I beat my body and make it my slave so that after I have preached to others, I myself will not be disqualified for the prize.

1 Corinthians 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 Remember our history, friends, and be warned. All our ancestors were led by the providential Cloud and taken miraculously through the Sea.
- 1 For I do not want you to be ignorant of the fact, brothers, that our forefathers were all under the cloud and that they all passed through the sea.
- 2 They went through the waters, in a baptism like ours, as Moses led them from enslaving death to salvation life.
- 2 They were all baptized into Moses in the cloud and in the sea.
- 3 They all ate
- 3 They all ate the same spiritual food
- 4 and drank identical food and drink, meals provided daily by God. They drank from the Rock, God's fountain for them that stayed with them wherever they were. And the Rock was Christ.

- 4 and drank the same spiritual drink; for they drank from the spiritual rock that accompanied them, and that rock was Christ.
- 5 But just experiencing God's wonder and grace didn't seem to mean much--most of them were defeated by temptation during the hard times in the desert, and God was not pleased.
- 5 Nevertheless, God was not pleased with most of them; their bodies were scattered over the desert.
- 6 The same thing could happen to us. We must be on guard so that we never get caught up in wanting our own way as they did.
- 6 Now these things occurred as examples to keep us from setting our hearts on evil things as they did.
- 7 And we must not turn our religion into a circus as they did--"First the people partied, then they threw a dance."
- 7 Do not be idolaters, as some of them were; as it is written: "The people sat down to eat and drink and got up to indulge in pagan revelry."
- 8 We must not be sexually promiscuous--they paid for that, remember, with twenty-three thousand deaths in one day!
- 8 We should not commit sexual immorality, as some of them did--and in one day twenty- three thousand of them died.
- 9 We must never try to get Christ to serve us instead of us serving him; they tried it, and God launched an epidemic of poisonous snakes.
- 9 We should not test the Lord, as some of them did--and were killed by snakes.
- 10 We must be careful not to stir up discontent; discontent destroyed them.
- 10 And do not grumble, as some of them did--and were killed by the destroying angel.
- 11 These are all warning markers--DANGER!--in our history books, written down so that we don't repeat their mistakes. Our positions in the story are parallel--they at the beginning, we at the end--and we are just as capable of messing it up as they were.
- 11 These things happened to them as examples and were written down as warnings for us, on whom the fulfillment of the ages has come.
- 12 Don't be so naive and self-confident. You're not exempt. You could fall flat on your face as easily as anyone else. Forget about self-confidence; it's useless. Cultivate God-confidence.

- 12 So, if you think you are standing firm, be careful that you don't fall!
- 13 No test or temptation that comes your way is beyond the course of what others have had to face. All you need to remember is that God will never let you down; he'll never let you be pushed past your limit; he'll always be there to help you come through it.
- 13 No temptation has seized you except what is common to man. And God is faithful; he will not let you be tempted beyond what you can bear. But when you are tempted, he will also provide a way out so that you can stand up under it.
- 14 So, my very dear friends, when you see people reducing God to something they can use or control, get out of their company as fast as you can.
- 14 Therefore, my dear friends, flee from idolatry.
- 15 I assume I'm addressing believers now who are mature. Draw your own conclusions:
- 15 I speak to sensible people; judge for yourselves what I say.
- 16 When we drink the cup of blessing, aren't we taking into ourselves the blood, the very life, of Christ? And isn't it the same with the loaf of bread we break and eat? Don't we take into ourselves the body, the very life, of Christ?
- 16 Is not the cup of thanksgiving for which we give thanks a participation in the blood of Christ? And is not the bread that we break a participation in the body of Christ?
- 17 Because there is one loaf, our many-ness becomes one-ness--Christ doesn't become fragmented in us. Rather, we become unified in him. We don't reduce Christ to what we are; he raises us to what he is.
- 17 Because there is one loaf, we, who are many, are one body, for we all partake of the one loaf.
- 18 That's basically what happened even in old Israel--those who ate the sacrifices offered on God's altar entered into God's action at the altar.
- 18 Consider the people of Israel: Do not those who eat the sacrifices participate in the altar?
- 19 Do you see the difference? Sacrifices offered to idols are offered to nothing, for what's the idol but a nothing?
- 19 Do I mean then that a sacrifice offered to an idol is anything, or that an idol is anything?

- 20 Or worse than nothing, a minus, a demon! I don't want you to become part of something that reduces you to less than yourself.
- 20 No, but the sacrifices of pagans are offered to demons, not to God, and I do not want you to be participants with demons.
- 21 And you can't have it both ways, banqueting with the Master one day and slumming with demons the next.
- 21 You cannot drink the cup of the Lord and the cup of demons too; you cannot have a part in both the Lord's table and the table of demons.
- 22 Besides, the Master won't put up with it. He wants us--all or nothing. Do you think you can get off with anything less?
- 22 Are we trying to arouse the Lord's jealousy? Are we stronger than he?
- 23 Looking at it one way, you could say, "Anything goes. Because of God's immense generosity and grace, we don't have to dissect and scrutinize every action to see if it will pass muster." But the point is not to just get by.
- 23 Everything is permissible--but not everything is beneficial. "Everything is permissible"--but not everything is constructive.
- 24 We want to live well, but our foremost efforts should be to help others live well.
- 24 Nobody should seek his own good, but the good of others.
- 25 With that as a base to work from, common sense can take you the rest of the way. Eat anything sold at the butcher shop, for instance; you don't have to run an "idolatry test" on every item.
- 25 Eat anything sold in the meat market without raising questions of conscience,
- 26 "The earth," after all, "is God's, and everything in it." That "everything" certainly includes the leg of lamb in the butcher shop.
- 26 for, "The earth is the Lord's, and everything in it."
- 27 If a nonbeliever invites you to dinner and you feel like going, go ahead and enjoy yourself; eat everything placed before you. It would be both bad manners and bad spirituality to cross-examine your host on the ethical purity of each course as it is served.
- 27 If some unbeliever invites you to a meal and you want to go, eat whatever is put before you without raising questions of conscience.
- 28 On the other hand, if he goes out of his way to tell you that this or that was sacrificed to god or goddess so-and-so, you should pass. Even

- though you may be indifferent as to where it came from, he isn't, and you don't want to send mixed messages to him about who you are worshiping.
- 28 But if anyone says to you, "This has been offered in sacrifice," then do not eat it, both for the sake of the man who told you and for conscience' sake--
- 29 But, except for these special cases, I'm not going to walk around on eggshells worrying about what small-minded people might say; I'm going to stride free and easy, knowing what our large-minded Master has already said.
- 29 the other man's conscience, I mean, not yours. For why should my freedom be judged by another's conscience?
- 30 If I eat what is served to me, grateful to God for what is on the table, how can I worry about what someone will say? I thanked God for it and he blessed it!
- 30 If I take part in the meal with thankfulness, why am I denounced because of something I thank God for?
- 31 So eat your meals heartily, not worrying about what others say about you--you're eating to God's glory, after all, not to please them. As a matter of fact, do everything that way, heartily and freely to God's glory.
- 31 So whether you eat or drink or whatever you do, do it all for the glory of God.
- 32 At the same time, don't be callous in your exercise of freedom, thoughtlessly stepping on the toes of those who aren't as free as you are.
- 32 Do not cause anyone to stumble, whether Jews, Greeks or the church of God--
- 33 I try my best to be considerate of everyone's feelings in all these matters; I hope you will be, too.
- 33 even as I try to please everybody in every way. For I am not seeking my own good but the good of many, so that they may be saved.

1 Corinthians 11

MSG

NIV

- 1 It pleases me that you continue to remember and honor me by keeping up the traditions of the faith I taught you. All actual authority stems from Christ.
- 1 Follow my example, as I follow the example of Christ.
- 2 (SEE 11:1)
- 2 I praise you for remembering me in everything and for holding to the teachings, just as I passed them on to you.
- 3 In a marriage relationship, there is authority from Christ to husband, and from husband to wife. The authority of Christ is the authority of God.
- 3 Now I want you to realize that the head of every man is Christ, and the head of the woman is man, and the head of Christ is God.
- 4 Any man who speaks with God or about God in a way that shows a lack of respect for the authority of Christ, dishonors Christ.
- 4 Every man who prays or prophesies with his head covered dishonors his head.
- 5 In the same way, a wife who speaks with God in a way that shows a lack of respect for the authority of her husband, dishonors her husband.
- 5 And every woman who prays or prophesies with her head uncovered dishonors her head--it is just as though her head were shaved.
- 6 Worse, she dishonors herself--an ugly sight, like a woman with her head shaved. This is basically the origin of these customs we have of women wearing head coverings in worship, while men take their hats off. By these symbolic acts,
- 6 If a woman does not cover her head, she should have her hair cut off; and if it is a disgrace for a woman to have her hair cut or shaved off, she should cover her head.
- 7 men and women, who far too often butt heads with each other, submit their "heads" to the Head: God.
- 7 A man ought not to cover his head, since he is the image and glory of God; but the woman is the glory of man.
- 8 (SEE 11:7)
- 8 For man did not come from woman, but woman from man;
- 9 (SEE 11:7)
- 9 neither was man created for woman, but woman for man.
- 10 Don't, by the way, read too much into the differences here between men and women.

- 10 For this reason, and because of the angels, the woman ought to have a sign of authority on her head.
- 11 Neither man nor woman can go it alone or claim priority. Man was created first, as a beautiful shining reflection of God--that is true. But the head on a woman's body clearly outshines in beauty the head of her "head," her husband.
- 11 In the Lord, however, woman is not independent of man, nor is man independent of woman.
- 12 The first woman came from man, true--but ever since then, every man comes from a woman! And since virtually everything comes from God anyway, let's quit going through these "who's first" routines.
- 12 For as woman came from man, so also man is born of woman. But everything comes from God.
- 13 Don't you agree there is something naturally powerful in the symbolism--a woman, her beautiful hair reminiscent of angels, praying in adoration; a man, his head bared in reverence, praying in submission?
- 13 Judge for yourselves: Is it proper for a woman to pray to God with her head uncovered?
- 14 (SEE 11:13)
- 14 Does not the very nature of things teach you that if a man has long hair, it is a disgrace to him,
- 15 (SEE 11:13)
- 15 but that if a woman has long hair, it is her glory? For long hair is given to her as a covering.
- 16 I hope you're not going to be argumentative about this. All God's churches see it this way; I don't want you standing out as an exception.
- 16 If anyone wants to be contentious about this, we have no other practice--nor do the churches of God.
- 17 Regarding this next item, I'm not at all pleased. I am getting the picture that when you meet together it brings out your worst side instead of your best!
- 17 In the following directives I have no praise for you, for your meetings do more harm than good.
- 18 First, I get this report on your divisiveness, competing with and criticizing each other. I'm reluctant to believe it, but there it is.

- 18 In the first place, I hear that when you come together as a church, there are divisions among you, and to some extent I believe it.
- 19 The best that can be said for it is that the testing process will bring truth into the open and confirm it.
- 19 No doubt there have to be differences among you to show which of you have God's approval.
- 20 And then I find that you bring your divisions to worship--you come together, and instead of eating the Lord's Supper,
- 20 When you come together, it is not the Lord's Supper you eat,
- 21 you bring in a lot of food from the outside and make pigs of yourselves. Some are left out, and go home hungry. Others have to be carried out, too drunk to walk. I can't believe it!
- 21 for as you eat, each of you goes ahead without waiting for anybody else. One remains hungry, another gets drunk.
- 22 Don't you have your own homes to eat and drink in? Why would you stoop to desecrating God's church? Why would you actually shame God's poor? I never would have believed you would stoop to this. And I'm not going to stand by and say nothing.
- 22 Don't you have homes to eat and drink in? Or do you despise the church of God and humiliate those who have nothing? What shall I say to you? Shall I praise you for this? Certainly not!
- 23 Let me go over with you again exactly what goes on in the Lord's Supper and why it is so centrally important. I received my instructions from the Master himself and passed them on to you. The Master, Jesus, on the night of his betrayal, took bread.
- 23 For I received from the Lord what I also passed on to you: The Lord Jesus, on the night he was betrayed, took bread,
- 24 Having given thanks, he broke it and said, This is my body, broken for you. Do this to remember me.
- 24 and when he had given thanks, he broke it and said, "This is my body, which is for you; do this in remembrance of me."
- 25 After supper, he did the same thing with the cup: This cup is my blood, my new covenant with you. Each time you drink this cup, remember me.
- 25 In the same way, after supper he took the cup, saying, "This cup is the new covenant in my blood; do this, whenever you drink it, in remembrance of me."

- 26 What you must solemnly realize is that every time you eat this bread and every time you drink this cup, you reenact in your words and actions the death of the Master. You will be drawn back to this meal again and again until the Master returns. You must never let familiarity breed contempt.
- 26 For whenever you eat this bread and drink this cup, you proclaim the Lord's death until he comes.
- 27 Anyone who eats the bread or drinks the cup of the Master irreverently is like part of the crowd that jeered and spit on him at his death. Is that the kind of "remembrance" you want to be part of?
- 27 Therefore, whoever eats the bread or drinks the cup of the Lord in an unworthy manner will be guilty of sinning against the body and blood of the Lord.
- 28 Examine your motives, test your heart, come to this meal in holy awe.
- 28 A man ought to examine himself before he eats of the bread and drinks of the cup.
- 29 If you give no thought (or worse, don't care) about the broken body of the Master when you eat and drink, you're running the risk of serious consequences.
- 29 For anyone who eats and drinks without recognizing the body of the Lord eats and drinks judgment on himself.
- 30 That's why so many of you even now are listless and sick, and others have gone to an early grave.
- 30 That is why many among you are weak and sick, and a number of you have fallen asleep.
- 31 If we get this straight now, we won't have to be straightened out later on.
- 31 But if we judged ourselves, we would not come under judgment.
- 32 Better to be confronted by the Master now than to face a fiery confrontation later.
- 32 When we are judged by the Lord, we are being disciplined so that we will not be condemned with the world.
- 33 So, my friends, when you come together to the Lord's Table, be reverent and courteous with one another.
- 33 So then, my brothers, when you come together to eat, wait for each other.

- 34 If you're so hungry that you can't wait to be served, go home and get a sandwich. But by no means risk turning this Meal into an eating and drinking binge or a family squabble. It is a spiritual meal--a love feast. The other things you asked about, I'll respond to in person when I make my next visit.
- 34 If anyone is hungry, he should eat at home, so that when you meet together it may not result in judgment. And when I come I will give further directions.

1 Corinthians 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 What I want to talk about now is the various ways God's Spirit gets worked into our lives. This is complex and often misunderstood, but I want you to be informed and knowledgeable.
- 1 Now about spiritual gifts, brothers, I do not want you to be ignorant.
- 2 Remember how you were when you didn't know God, led from one phony god to another, never knowing what you were doing, just doing it because everybody else did it? It's different in this life. God wants us to use our intelligence, to seek to understand as well as we can.
- 2 You know that when you were pagans, somehow or other you were influenced and led astray to mute idols.
- 3 For instance, by using your heads, you know perfectly well that the Spirit of God would never prompt anyone to say "Jesus be damned!" Nor would anyone be inclined to say "Jesus is Master!" without the insight of the Holy Spirit.
- 3 Therefore I tell you that no one who is speaking by the Spirit of God says, "Jesus be cursed," and no one can say, "Jesus is Lord," except by the Holy Spirit.
- 4 God's various gifts are handed out everywhere; but they all originate in God's Spirit.
- 4 There are different kinds of gifts, but the same Spirit.
- 5 God's various ministries are carried out everywhere; but they all originate in God's Spirit.
- 5 There are different kinds of service, but the same Lord.

- 6 God's various expressions of power are in action everywhere; but God himself is behind it all.
- 6 There are different kinds of working, but the same God works all of them in all men.
- 7 Each person is given something to do that shows who God is: Everyone gets in on it, everyone benefits. All kinds of things are handed out by the Spirit, and to all kinds of people!
- 7 Now to each one the manifestation of the Spirit is given for the common good.
- 8 The variety is wonderful: wise counsel clear understanding
- 8 To one there is given through the Spirit the message of wisdom, to another the message of knowledge by means of the same Spirit,
- 9 simple trust healing the sick
- 9 to another faith by the same Spirit, to another gifts of healing by that one Spirit,
- 10 miraculous acts proclamation distinguishing between spirits tongues interpretation of tongues.
- 10 to another miraculous powers, to another prophecy, to another distinguishing between spirits, to another speaking in different kinds of tongues, and to still another the interpretation of tongues.
- 11 All these gifts have a common origin, but are handed out one by one by the one Spirit of God. He decides who gets what, and when.
- 11 All these are the work of one and the same Spirit, and he gives them to each one, just as he determines.
- 12 You can easily enough see how this kind of thing works by looking no further than your own body. Your body has many parts--limbs, organs, cells--but no matter how many parts you can name, you're still one body. It's exactly the same with Christ.
- 12 The body is a unit, though it is made up of many parts; and though all its parts are many, they form one body. So it is with Christ.
- 13 By means of his one Spirit, we all said good-bye to our partial and piecemeal lives. We each used to independently call our own shots, but then we entered into a large and integrated life in which he has the final say in everything. (This is what we proclaimed in word and action when we were baptized.) Each of us is now a part of his resurrection body, refreshed and sustained at one fountain--his Spirit--where we all come to

drink. The old labels we once used to identify ourselves--labels like Jew or Greek, slave or free--are no longer useful. We need something larger, more comprehensive.

13 For we were all baptized by one Spirit into one body-- whether Jews or Greeks, slave or free--and we were all given the one Spirit to drink.

14 I want you to think about how all this makes you more significant, not less. A body isn't just a single part blown up into something huge. It's all the different-but-similar parts arranged and functioning together.

14 Now the body is not made up of one part but of many.

15 If Foot said, "I'm not elegant like Hand, embellished with rings; I guess I don't belong to this body," would that make it so?

15 If the foot should say, "Because I am not a hand, I do not belong to the body," it would not for that reason cease to be part of the body.

16 If Ear said, "I'm not beautiful like Eye, limpid and expressive; I don't deserve a place on the head," would you want to remove it from the body?

16 And if the ear should say, "Because I am not an eye, I do not belong to the body," it would not for that reason cease to be part of the body.

17 If the body was all eye, how could it hear? If all ear, how could it smell?

17 If the whole body were an eye, where would the sense of hearing be? If the whole body were an ear, where would the sense of smell be?

18 As it is, we see that God has carefully placed each part of the body right where he wanted it.

18 But in fact God has arranged the parts in the body, every one of them, just as he wanted them to be.

19 But I also want you to think about how this keeps your significance from getting blown up into self-importance. For no matter how significant you are, it is only because of what you are a part of. An enormous eye or a gigantic hand wouldn't be a body, but a monster.

19 If they were all one part, where would the body be?

20 What we have is one body with many parts, each its proper size and in its proper place. No part is important on its own.

20 As it is, there are many parts, but one body.

21 Can you imagine Eye telling Hand, "Get lost; I don't need you"? Or, Head telling Foot, "You're fired; your job has been phased out"?

- 21 The eye cannot say to the hand, "I don't need you!" And the head cannot say to the feet, "I don't need you!"
- 22 As a matter of fact, in practice it works the other way--the "lower" the part, the more basic, and therefore necessary. You can live without an eye, for instance, but not without a stomach.
- 22 On the contrary, those parts of the body that seem to be weaker are indispensable,
- 23 When it's a part of your own body you are concerned with, it makes no difference whether the part is visible or clothed, higher or lower. You give it dignity and honor just as it is, without comparisons.
- 23 and the parts that we think are less honorable we treat with special honor. And the parts that are unpresentable are treated with special modesty,
- 24 If anything, you have more concern for the lower parts than the higher. If you had to choose, wouldn't you prefer good digestion to full-bodied hair?
- 24 while our presentable parts need no special treatment. But God has combined the members of the body and has given greater honor to the parts that lacked it,
- 25 The way God designed our bodies is a model for understanding our lives together as a church: every part dependent on every other part, the parts we mention and the parts we don't,
- 25 so that there should be no division in the body, but that its parts should have equal concern for each other.
- 26 the parts we see and the parts we don't. If one part hurts, every other part is involved in the hurt, and in the healing. If one part flourishes, every other part enters into the exuberance.
- 26 If one part suffers, every part suffers with it; if one part is honored, every part rejoices with it.
- 27 You are Christ's body--that's who you are! You must never forget this. Only as you accept your part of that body does your "part" mean anything.
- 27 Now you are the body of Christ, and each one of you is a part of it.
- 28 You're familiar with some of the parts that God has formed in his church, which is his "body": apostles prophets teachers miracle workers healers helpers organizers those who pray in tongues.

- 28 And in the church God has appointed first of all apostles, second prophets, third teachers, then workers of miracles, also those having gifts of healing, those able to help others, those with gifts of administration, and those speaking in different kinds of tongues.
- 29 But it's obvious by now, isn't it, that Christ's church is a complete Body and not a gigantic, unidimensional Part? It's not all Apostle, not all Prophet, not all Miracle Worker,
- 29 Are all apostles? Are all prophets? Are all teachers? Do all work miracles?
- 30 not all Healer, not all Prayer in Tongues, not all Interpreter of Tongues.
- 30 Do all have gifts of healing? Do all speak in tongues? Do all interpret?
- 31 And yet some of you keep competing for so-called "important" parts. But now I want to lay out a far better way for you.
- 31 But eagerly desire the greater gifts. And now I will show you the most excellent way.

1 Corinthians 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 If I speak with human eloquence and angelic ecstasy but don't love, I'm nothing but the creaking of a rusty gate.
- 1 If I speak in the tongues of men and of angels, but have not love, I am only a resounding gong or a clanging cymbal.
- 2 If I speak God's Word with power, revealing all his mysteries and making everything plain as day, and if I have faith that says to a mountain, "Jump," and it jumps, but I don't love, I'm nothing.
- 2 If I have the gift of prophecy and can fathom all mysteries and all knowledge, and if I have a faith that can move mountains, but have not love, I am nothing.
- 3 If I give everything I own to the poor and even go to the stake to be burned as a martyr, but I don't love, I've gotten nowhere. So, no matter what I say, what I believe, and what I do, I'm bankrupt without love.
- 3 If I give all I possess to the poor and surrender my body to the flames, but have not love, I gain nothing.

- 4 Love never gives up. Love cares more for others than for self. Love doesn't want what it doesn't have. Love doesn't strut, Doesn't have a swelled head,
- 4 Love is patient, love is kind. It does not envy, it does not boast, it is not proud.
- 5 Doesn't force itself on others, Isn't always "me first," Doesn't fly off the handle, Doesn't keep score of the sins of others,
- 5 It is not rude, it is not self-seeking, it is not easily angered, it keeps no record of wrongs.
- 6 Doesn't revel when others grovel, Takes pleasure in the flowering of truth,
- 6 Love does not delight in evil but rejoices with the truth.
- 7 Puts up with anything, Trusts God always, Always looks for the best, Never looks back, But keeps going to the end.
- 7 It always protects, always trusts, always hopes, always perseveres.
- 8 Love never dies. Inspired speech will be over some day; praying in tongues will end; understanding will reach its limit.
- 8 Love never fails. But where there are prophecies, they will cease; where there are tongues, they will be stilled; where there is knowledge, it will pass away.
- 9 We know only a portion of the truth, and what we say about God is always incomplete.
- 9 For we know in part and we prophesy in part,
- 10 But when the Complete arrives, our incompletes will be canceled.
- 10 but when perfection comes, the imperfect disappears.
- 11 When I was an infant at my mother's breast, I gurgled and cooed like any infant. When I grew up, I left those infant ways for good.
- 11 When I was a child, I talked like a child, I thought like a child, I reasoned like a child. When I became a man, I put childish ways behind me.
- 12 We don't yet see things clearly. We're squinting in a fog, peering through a mist. But it won't be long before the weather clears and the sun shines bright! We'll see it all then, see it all as clearly as God sees us, knowing him directly just as he knows us!
- 12 Now we see but a poor reflection as in a mirror; then we shall see face to face. Now I know in part; then I shall know fully, even as I am fully

known.

13 But for right now, until that completeness, we have three things to do to lead us toward that consummation: Trust steadily in God, hope unswervingly, love extravagantly. And the best of the three is love.

13 And now these three remain: faith, hope and love. But the greatest of these is love.

1 Corinthians 14

MSG

NIV

- 1 Go after a life of love as if your life depended on it--because it does. Give yourselves to the gifts God gives you. Most of all, try to proclaim his truth.
- 1 Follow the way of love and eagerly desire spiritual gifts, especially the gift of prophecy.
- 2 If you praise him in the private language of tongues, God understands you but no one else does, for you are sharing intimacies just between you and him.
- 2 For anyone who speaks in a tongue does not speak to men but to God. Indeed, no one understands him; he utters mysteries with his spirit.
- 3 But when you proclaim his truth in everyday speech, you're letting others in on the truth so that they can grow and be strong and experience his presence with you.
- 3 But everyone who prophesies speaks to men for their strengthening, encouragement and comfort.
- 4 The one who prays using a private "prayer language" certainly gets a lot out of it, but proclaiming God's truth to the church in its common language brings the whole church into growth and strength.
- 4 He who speaks in a tongue edifies himself, but he who prophesies edifies the church.
- 5 I want all of you to develop intimacies with God in prayer, but please don't stop with that. Go on and proclaim his clear truth to others. It's more important that everyone have access to the knowledge and love of God in language everyone understands than that you go off and cultivate

- God's presence in a mysterious prayer language--unless, of course, there is someone who can interpret what you are saying for the benefit of all.
- 5 I would like every one of you to speak in tongues, but I would rather have you prophesy. He who prophesies is greater than one who speaks in tongues, unless he interprets, so that the church may be edified.
- 6 Think, friends: If I come to you and all I do is pray privately to God in a way only he can understand, what are you going to get out of that? If I don't address you plainly with some insight or truth or proclamation or teaching, what help am I to you?
- 6 Now, brothers, if I come to you and speak in tongues, what good will I be to you, unless I bring you some revelation or knowledge or prophecy or word of instruction?
- 7 If musical instruments--flutes, say, or harps--aren't played so that each note is distinct and in tune, how will anyone be able to catch the melody and enjoy the music?
- 7 Even in the case of lifeless things that make sounds, such as the flute or harp, how will anyone know what tune is being played unless there is a distinction in the notes?
- 8 If the trumpet call can't be distinguished, will anyone show up for the battle?
- 8 Again, if the trumpet does not sound a clear call, who will get ready for battle?
- 9 So if you speak in a way no one can understand, what's the point of opening your mouth?
- 9 So it is with you. Unless you speak intelligible words with your tongue, how will anyone know what you are saying? You will just be speaking into the air.
- 10 There are many languages in the world and they all mean something to someone.
- 10 Undoubtedly there are all sorts of languages in the world, yet none of them is without meaning.
- 11 But if I don't understand the language, it's not going to do me much good.
- 11 If then I do not grasp the meaning of what someone is saying, I am a foreigner to the speaker, and he is a foreigner to me.

- 12 It's no different with you. Since you're so eager to participate in what God is doing, why don't you concentrate on doing what helps everyone in the church?
- 12 So it is with you. Since you are eager to have spiritual gifts, try to excel in gifts that build up the church.
- 13 So, when you pray in your private prayer language, don't hoard the experience for yourself. Pray for the insight and ability to bring others into that intimacy.
- 13 For this reason anyone who speaks in a tongue should pray that he may interpret what he says.
- 14 If I pray in tongues, my spirit prays but my mind lies fallow, and all that intelligence is wasted.
- 14 For if I pray in a tongue, my spirit prays, but my mind is unfruitful.
- 15 So what's the solution? The answer is simple enough. Do both. I should be spiritually free and expressive as I pray, but I should also be thoughtful and mindful as I pray. I should sing with my spirit, and sing with my mind.
- 15 So what shall I do? I will pray with my spirit, but I will also pray with my mind; I will sing with my spirit, but I will also sing with my mind.
- 16 If you give a blessing using your private prayer language, which no one else understands, how can some outsider who has just shown up and has no idea what's going on know when to say "Amen"?
- 16 If you are praising God with your spirit, how can one who finds himself among those who do not understand say "Amen" to your thanksgiving, since he does not know what you are saying?
- 17 Your blessing might be beautiful, but you have very effectively cut that person out of it.
- 17 You may be giving thanks well enough, but the other man is not edified.
- 18 I'm grateful to God for the gift of praying in tongues that he gives us for praising him, which leads to wonderful intimacies we enjoy with him. I enter into this as much or more than any of you.
- 18 I thank God that I speak in tongues more than all of you.
- 19 But when I'm in a church assembled for worship, I'd rather say five words that everyone can understand and learn from than say ten thousand that sound to others like gibberish.

- 19 But in the church I would rather speak five intelligible words to instruct others than ten thousand words in a tongue.
- 20 To be perfectly frank, I'm getting exasperated with your infantile thinking. How long before you grow up and use your head--your adult head? It's all right to have a childlike unfamiliarity with evil; a simple no is all that's needed there. But there's far more to saying yes to something. Only mature and well-exercised intelligence can save you from falling into gullibility.
- 20 Brothers, stop thinking like children. In regard to evil be infants, but in your thinking be adults.
- 21 It's written in Scripture that God said, In strange tongues and from the mouths of strangers I will preach to this people, but they'll neither listen nor believe.
- 21 In the Law it is written: "Through men of strange tongues and through the lips of foreigners I will speak to this people, but even then they will not listen to me," says the Lord.
- 22 So where does it get you, all this speaking in tongues no one understands? It doesn't help believers, and it only gives unbelievers something to gawk at. Plain truth-speaking, on the other hand, goes straight to the heart of believers and doesn't get in the way of unbelievers.
- 22 Tongues, then, are a sign, not for believers but for unbelievers; prophecy, however, is for believers, not for unbelievers.
- 23 If you come together as a congregation and some unbelieving outsiders walk in on you as you're all praying in tongues, unintelligible to each other and to them, won't they assume you've taken leave of your senses and get out of there as fast as they can?
- 23 So if the whole church comes together and everyone speaks in tongues, and some who do not understand or some unbelievers come in, will they not say that you are out of your mind?
- 24 But if some unbelieving outsiders walk in on a service where people are speaking out God's truth, the plain words will bring them up against the truth
- 24 But if an unbeliever or someone who does not understand comes in while everybody is prophesying, he will be convinced by all that he is a sinner and will be judged by all,

- 25 and probe their hearts. Before you know it, they're going to be on their faces before God, recognizing that God is among you.
- 25 and the secrets of his heart will be laid bare. So he will fall down and worship God, exclaiming, "God is really among you!"
- 26 So here's what I want you to do. When you gather for worship, each one of you be prepared with something that will be useful for all: Sing a hymn, teach a lesson, tell a story, lead a prayer, provide an insight.
- 26 What then shall we say, brothers? When you come together, everyone has a hymn, or a word of instruction, a revelation, a tongue or an interpretation. All of these must be done for the strengthening of the church.
- 27 If prayers are offered in tongues, two or three's the limit, and then only if someone is present who can interpret what you're saying.
- 27 If anyone speaks in a tongue, two--or at the most three--should speak, one at a time, and someone must interpret.
- 28 Otherwise, keep it between God and yourself.
- 28 If there is no interpreter, the speaker should keep quiet in the church and speak to himself and God.
- 29 And no more than two or three speakers at a meeting, with the rest of you listening and taking it to heart.
- 29 Two or three prophets should speak, and the others should weigh carefully what is said.
- 30 Take your turn, no one person taking over.
- 30 And if a revelation comes to someone who is sitting down, the first speaker should stop.
- 31 Then each speaker gets a chance to say something special from God, and you all learn from each other.
- 31 For you can all prophesy in turn so that everyone may be instructed and encouraged.
- 32 If you choose to speak, you're also responsible for how and when you speak.
- 32 The spirits of prophets are subject to the control of prophets.
- 33 When we worship the right way, God doesn't stir us up into confusion; he brings us into harmony. This goes for all the churches--no exceptions.
- 33 For God is not a God of disorder but of peace. As in all the congregations of the saints,

- 34 Wives must not disrupt worship, talking when they should be listening,
34 women should remain silent in the churches. They are not allowed to speak, but must be in submission, as the Law says.
- 35 asking questions that could more appropriately be asked of their husbands at home. God's Book of the law guides our manners and customs here. Wives have no license to use the time of worship for unwarranted speaking.
- 35 If they want to inquire about something, they should ask their own husbands at home; for it is disgraceful for a woman to speak in the church.
- 36 Do you--both women and men--imagine that you're a sacred oracle determining what's right and wrong? Do you think everything revolves around you?
- 36 Did the word of God originate with you? Or are you the only people it has reached?
- 37 If any one of you thinks God has something for you to say or has inspired you to do something, pay close attention to what I have written. This is the way the Master wants it.
- 37 If anybody thinks he is a prophet or spiritually gifted, let him acknowledge that what I am writing to you is the Lord's command.
- 38 If you won't play by these rules, God can't use you. Sorry.
- 38 If he ignores this, he himself will be ignored.
- 39 Three things, then, to sum this up: When you speak forth God's truth, speak your heart out. Don't tell people how they should or shouldn't pray when they're praying in tongues that you don't understand.
- 39 Therefore, my brothers, be eager to prophesy, and do not forbid speaking in tongues.
- 40 Be courteous and considerate in everything.
- 40 But everything should be done in a fitting and orderly way.

1 Corinthians 15

MSG

NIV

- 1 Friends, let me go over the Message with you one final time--this Message that I proclaimed and that you made your own; this Message on

which you took your stand

- 1 Now, brothers, I want to remind you of the gospel I preached to you, which you received and on which you have taken your stand.
- 2 and by which your life has been saved. (I'm assuming, now, that your belief was the real thing and not a passing fancy, that you're in this for good and holding fast.)
- 2 By this gospel you are saved, if you hold firmly to the word I preached to you. Otherwise, you have believed in vain.
- 3 The first thing I did was place before you what was placed so emphatically before me: that the Messiah died for our sins, exactly as Scripture tells it;
- 3 For what I received I passed on to you as of first importance: that Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures,
- 4 that he was buried; that he was raised from death on the third day, again exactly as Scripture says;
- 4 that he was buried, that he was raised on the third day according to the Scriptures,
- 5 that he presented himself alive to Peter, then to his closest followers,
- 5 and that he appeared to Peter, and then to the Twelve.
- 6 and later to more than five hundred of his followers all at the same time, most of them still around (although a few have since died);
- 6 After that, he appeared to more than five hundred of the brothers at the same time, most of whom are still living, though some have fallen asleep.
- 7 that he then spent time with James and the rest of those he commissioned to represent him;
- 7 Then he appeared to James, then to all the apostles,
- 8 and that he finally presented himself alive to me.
- 8 and last of all he appeared to me also, as to one abnormally born.
- 9 It was fitting that I bring up the rear. I don't deserve to be included in that inner circle, as you well know, having spent all those early years trying my best to stamp God's church right out of existence.
- 9 For I am the least of the apostles and do not even deserve to be called an apostle, because I persecuted the church of God.
- 10 But because God was so gracious, so very generous, here I am. And I'm not about to let his grace go to waste. Haven't I worked hard trying to do

more than any of the others? Even then, my work didn't amount to all that much. It was God giving me the work to do, God giving me the energy to do it.

10 But by the grace of God I am what I am, and his grace to me was not without effect. No, I worked harder than all of them--yet not I, but the grace of God that was with me.

11 So whether you heard it from me or from those others, it's all the same: We spoke God's truth and you entrusted your lives.

11 Whether, then, it was I or they, this is what we preach, and this is what you believed.

12 Now, let me ask you something profound yet troubling. If you became believers because you trusted the proclamation that Christ is alive, risen from the dead, how can you let people say that there is no such thing as a resurrection?

12 But if it is preached that Christ has been raised from the dead, how can some of you say that there is no resurrection of the dead?

13 If there's no resurrection, there's no living Christ.

13 If there is no resurrection of the dead, then not even Christ has been raised.

14 And face it--if there's no resurrection for Christ, everything we've told you is smoke and mirrors, and everything you've staked your life on is smoke and mirrors.

14 And if Christ has not been raised, our preaching is useless and so is your faith.

15 Not only that, but we would be guilty of telling a string of barefaced lies about God, all these affidavits we passed on to you verifying that God raised up Christ--sheer fabrications, if there's no resurrection.

15 More than that, we are then found to be false witnesses about God, for we have testified about God that he raised Christ from the dead. But he did not raise him if in fact the dead are not raised.

16 If corpses can't be raised, then Christ wasn't, because he was indeed dead.

16 For if the dead are not raised, then Christ has not been raised either.

17 And if Christ wasn't raised, then all you're doing is wandering about in the dark, as lost as ever.

- 17 And if Christ has not been raised, your faith is futile; you are still in your sins.
- 18 It's even worse for those who died hoping in Christ and resurrection, because they're already in their graves.
- 18 Then those also who have fallen asleep in Christ are lost.
- 19 If all we get out of Christ is a little inspiration for a few short years, we're a pretty sorry lot.
- 19 If only for this life we have hope in Christ, we are to be pitied more than all men.
- 20 But the truth is that Christ has been raised up, the first in a long legacy of those who are going to leave the cemeteries.
- 20 But Christ has indeed been raised from the dead, the firstfruits of those who have fallen asleep.
- 21 There is a nice symmetry in this: Death initially came by a man, and resurrection from death came by a man.
- 21 For since death came through a man, the resurrection of the dead comes also through a man.
- 22 Everybody dies in Adam; everybody comes alive in Christ.
- 22 For as in Adam all die, so in Christ all will be made alive.
- 23 But we have to wait our turn: Christ is first, then those with him at his Coming,
- 23 But each in his own turn: Christ, the firstfruits; then, when he comes, those who belong to him.
- 24 the grand consummation when, after crushing the opposition, he hands over his kingdom to God the Father.
- 24 Then the end will come, when he hands over the kingdom to God the Father after he has destroyed all dominion, authority and power.
- 25 He won't let up until the last enemy is down--
- 25 For he must reign until he has put all his enemies under his feet.
- 26 and the very last enemy is death!
- 26 The last enemy to be destroyed is death.
- 27 As the psalmist said, "He laid them low, one and all; he walked all over them." When Scripture says that "he walked all over them," it's obvious that he couldn't at the same time be walked on.
- 27 For he "has put everything under his feet." Now when it says that "everything" has been put under him, it is clear that this does not include

God himself, who put everything under Christ.

- 28 When everything and everyone is finally under God's rule, the Son will step down, taking his place with everyone else, showing that God's rule is absolutely comprehensive--a perfect ending!
- 28 When he has done this, then the Son himself will be made subject to him who put everything under him, so that God may be all in all.
- 29 Why do you think people offer themselves to be baptized for those already in the grave? If there's no chance of resurrection for a corpse, if God's power stops at the cemetery gates, why do we keep doing things that suggest he's going to clean the place out someday, pulling everyone up on their feet alive?
- 29 Now if there is no resurrection, what will those do who are baptized for the dead? If the dead are not raised at all, why are people baptized for them?
- 30 And why do you think I keep risking my neck in this dangerous work?
- 30 And as for us, why do we endanger ourselves every hour?
- 31 I look death in the face practically every day I live. Do you think I'd do this if I wasn't convinced of your resurrection and mine as guaranteed by the resurrected Messiah Jesus?
- 31 I die every day--I mean that, brothers--just as surely as I glory over you in Christ Jesus our Lord.
- 32 Do you think I was just trying to act heroic when I fought the wild beasts at Ephesus, hoping it wouldn't be the end of me? Not on your life! It's resurrection, resurrection, always resurrection, that undergirds what I do and say, the way I live. If there's no resurrection, "We eat, we drink, the next day we die," and that's all there is to it.
- 32 If I fought wild beasts in Ephesus for merely human reasons, what have I gained? If the dead are not raised, "Let us eat and drink, for tomorrow we die."
- 33 But don't fool yourselves. Don't let yourselves be poisoned by this anti-resurrection loose talk. "Bad company ruins good manners."
- 33 Do not be misled: "Bad company corrupts good character."
- 34 Think straight. Awaken to the holiness of life. No more playing fast and loose with resurrection facts. Ignorance of God is a luxury you can't afford in times like these. Aren't you embarrassed that you've let this kind of thing go on as long as you have?

- 34 Come back to your senses as you ought, and stop sinning; for there are some who are ignorant of God--I say this to your shame.
- 35 Some skeptic is sure to ask, "Show me how resurrection works. Give me a diagram; draw me a picture. What does this 'resurrection body' look like?"
- 35 But someone may ask, "How are the dead raised? With what kind of body will they come?"
- 36 If you look at this question closely, you realize how absurd it is. There are no diagrams for this kind of thing.
- 36 How foolish! What you sow does not come to life unless it dies.
- 37 We do have a parallel experience in gardening. You plant a "dead" seed; soon there is a flourishing plant. There is no visual likeness between seed and plant.
- 37 When you sow, you do not plant the body that will be, but just a seed, perhaps of wheat or of something else.
- 38 You could never guess what a tomato would look like by looking at a tomato seed. What we plant in the soil and what grows out of it don't look anything alike. The dead body that we bury in the ground and the resurrection body that comes from it will be dramatically different.
- 38 But God gives it a body as he has determined, and to each kind of seed he gives its own body.
- 39 You will notice that the variety of bodies is stunning. Just as there are different kinds of seeds, there are different kinds of bodies--humans, animals, birds, fish--each unprecedented in its form.
- 39 All flesh is not the same: Men have one kind of flesh, animals have another, birds another and fish another.
- 40 You get a hint at the diversity of resurrection glory by looking at the diversity of bodies not only on earth but in the skies--
- 40 There are also heavenly bodies and there are earthly bodies; but the splendor of the heavenly bodies is one kind, and the splendor of the earthly bodies is another.
- 41 sun, moon, stars--all these varieties of beauty and brightness. And we're only looking at pre-resurrection "seeds"--who can imagine what the resurrection "plants" will be like!
- 41 The sun has one kind of splendor, the moon another and the stars another; and star differs from star in splendor.

- 42 This image of planting a dead seed and raising a live plant is a mere sketch at best, but perhaps it will help in approaching the mystery of the resurrection body--but only if you keep in mind that when we're raised, we're raised for good, alive forever!
- 42 So will it be with the resurrection of the dead. The body that is sown is perishable, it is raised imperishable;
- 43 The corpse that's planted is no beauty, but when it's raised, it's glorious. Put in the ground weak, it comes up powerful.
- 43 it is sown in dishonor, it is raised in glory; it is sown in weakness, it is raised in power;
- 44 The seed sown is natural; the seed grown is supernatural--same seed, same body, but what a difference from when it goes down in physical mortality to when it is raised up in spiritual immortality!
- 44 it is sown a natural body, it is raised a spiritual body. If there is a natural body, there is also a spiritual body.
- 45 We follow this sequence in Scripture: The First Adam received life, the Last Adam is a life-giving Spirit.
- 45 So it is written: "The first man Adam became a living being" ; the last Adam, a life-giving spirit.
- 46 Physical life comes first, then spiritual--
- 46 The spiritual did not come first, but the natural, and after that the spiritual.
- 47 a firm base shaped from the earth, a final completion coming out of heaven.
- 47 The first man was of the dust of the earth, the second man from heaven.
- 48 The First Man was made out of earth, and people since then are earthy; the Second Man was made out of heaven, and people now can be heavenly.
- 48 As was the earthly man, so are those who are of the earth; and as is the man from heaven, so also are those who are of heaven.
- 49 In the same way that we've worked from our earthy origins, let's embrace our heavenly ends.
- 49 And just as we have borne the likeness of the earthly man, so shall we bear the likeness of the man from heaven.
- 50 I need to emphasize, friends, that our natural, earthy lives don't in themselves lead us by their very nature into the kingdom of God. Their

very "nature" is to die, so how could they "naturally" end up in the Life kingdom?

50 I declare to you, brothers, that flesh and blood cannot inherit the kingdom of God, nor does the perishable inherit the imperishable.

51 But let me tell you something wonderful, a mystery I'll probably never fully understand. We're not all going to die--but we are all going to be changed.

51 Listen, I tell you a mystery: We will not all sleep, but we will all be changed--

52 You hear a blast to end all blasts from a trumpet, and in the time that you look up and blink your eyes--it's over. On signal from that trumpet from heaven, the dead will be up and out of their graves, beyond the reach of death, never to die again. At the same moment and in the same way, we'll all be changed.

52 in a flash, in the twinkling of an eye, at the last trumpet. For the trumpet will sound, the dead will be raised imperishable, and we will be changed.

53 In the resurrection scheme of things, this has to happen: everything perishable taken off the shelves and replaced by the imperishable, this mortal replaced by the immortal.

53 For the perishable must clothe itself with the imperishable, and the mortal with immortality.

54 Then the saying will come true: Death swallowed by triumphant Life!

54 When the perishable has been clothed with the imperishable, and the mortal with immortality, then the saying that is written will come true: "Death has been swallowed up in victory."

55 Who got the last word, oh, Death? Oh, Death, who's afraid of you now?

55 Where, O death, is your victory? Where, O death, is your sting?

56 It was sin that made death so frightening and law-code guilt that gave sin its leverage, its destructive power.

56 The sting of death is sin, and the power of sin is the law.

57 But now in a single victorious stroke of Life, all three--sin, guilt, death--are gone, the gift of our Master, Jesus Christ. Thank God!

57 But thanks be to God! He gives us the victory through our Lord Jesus Christ.

58 With all this going for us, my dear, dear friends, stand your ground. And don't hold back. Throw yourselves into the work of the Master, confident

that nothing you do for him is a waste of time or effort.

58 Therefore, my dear brothers, stand firm. Let nothing move you. Always give yourselves fully to the work of the Lord, because you know that your labor in the Lord is not in vain.

1 Corinthians 16

MSG

NIV

- 1 Regarding the relief offering for poor Christians that is being collected, you get the same instructions I gave the churches in Galatia.
- 1 Now about the collection for God's people: Do what I told the Galatian churches to do.
- 2 Every Sunday each of you make an offering and put it in safekeeping. Be as generous as you can. When I get there you'll have it ready, and I won't have to make a special appeal.
- 2 On the first day of every week, each one of you should set aside a sum of money in keeping with his income, saving it up, so that when I come no collections will have to be made.
- 3 Then after I arrive, I'll write letters authorizing whomever you delegate, and send them off to Jerusalem to deliver your gift.
- 3 Then, when I arrive, I will give letters of introduction to the men you approve and send them with your gift to Jerusalem.
- 4 If you think it best that I go along, I'll be glad to travel with them.
- 4 If it seems advisable for me to go also, they will accompany me.
- 5 I plan to visit you after passing through northern Greece. I won't be staying long there,
- 5 After I go through Macedonia, I will come to you--for I will be going through Macedonia.
- 6 but maybe I can stay awhile with you--maybe even spend the winter? Then you could give me a good send-off, wherever I may be headed next.
- 6 Perhaps I will stay with you awhile, or even spend the winter, so that you can help me on my journey, wherever I go.
- 7 I don't want to just drop by in between other "primary" destinations. I want a good, long, leisurely visit. If the Master agrees, we'll have it!

- 7 I do not want to see you now and make only a passing visit; I hope to spend some time with you, if the Lord permits.
- 8 For the present, I'm staying right here in Ephesus.
- 8 But I will stay on at Ephesus until Pentecost,
- 9 A huge door of opportunity for good work has opened up here. (There is also mushrooming opposition.)
- 9 because a great door for effective work has opened to me, and there are many who oppose me.
- 10 If Timothy shows up, take good care of him. Make him feel completely at home among you. He works so hard for the Master, just as I do.
- 10 If Timothy comes, see to it that he has nothing to fear while he is with you, for he is carrying on the work of the Lord, just as I am.
- 11 Don't let anyone disparage him. After a while, send him on to me with your blessing. Tell him I'm expecting him, and any friends he has with him.
- 11 No one, then, should refuse to accept him. Send him on his way in peace so that he may return to me. I am expecting him along with the brothers.
- 12 About our friend Apollos, I've done my best to get him to pay you a visit, but haven't talked him into it yet. He doesn't think this is the right time. But there will be a "right time."
- 12 Now about our brother Apollos: I strongly urged him to go to you with the brothers. He was quite unwilling to go now, but he will go when he has the opportunity.
- 13 Keep your eyes open, hold tight to your convictions, give it all you've got, be resolute,
- 13 Be on your guard; stand firm in the faith; be men of courage; be strong.
- 14 and love without stopping.
- 14 Do everything in love.
- 15 Would you do me a favor, friends, and give special recognition to the family of Stephanas? You know, they were among the first converts in Greece, and they've put themselves out, serving Christians ever since then. I want you to
- 15 You know that the household of Stephanas were the first converts in Achaia, and they have devoted themselves to the service of the saints. I urge you, brothers,

16 honor and look up to people like that: companions and workers who show us how to do it, giving us something to aspire to.

16 to submit to such as these and to everyone who joins in the work, and labors at it.

17 I want you to know how delighted I am to have Stephanas, Fortunatus, and Achaicus here with me. They partially make up for your absence!

17 I was glad when Stephanas, Fortunatus and Achaicus arrived, because they have supplied what was lacking from you.

18 They've refreshed me by keeping me in touch with you. Be proud that you have people like this among you.

18 For they refreshed my spirit and yours also. Such men deserve recognition.

19 The churches here in western Asia send greetings. Aquila, Priscilla, and the church that meets in their house say hello.

19 The churches in the province of Asia send you greetings. Aquila and Priscilla greet you warmly in the Lord, and so does the church that meets at their house.

20 All the friends here say hello. Pass the greetings around with holy embraces!

20 All the brothers here send you greetings. Greet one another with a holy kiss.

21 And I, Paul--in my own handwriting!--send you my regards.

21 I, Paul, write this greeting in my own hand.

22 If anyone won't love the Master, throw him out. Make room for the Master!

22 If anyone does not love the Lord--a curse be on him. Come, O Lord!

23 Our Master Jesus has his arms wide open for you.

23 The grace of the Lord Jesus be with you.

24 And I love all of you in the Messiah, in Jesus.

24 My love to all of you in Christ Jesus. Amen.